

ShopSphere Operations

Enterprise Customer Support Knowledge Base (Vol 3)

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KB-011: Samsung TV Warranty and Installation Support

Document Owner: Home Entertainment Operations | **Applicability:** Tier 1 & Tier 2 Support Agents |
Related Systems: Field Service Management (FSM), Order Management System (OMS)

1. Overview and Warranty Eligibility

This document outlines the standard operating procedures for Samsung Television post-purchase support, covering installation, basic diagnostics, and warranty claims. All new Samsung TVs purchased through ShopSphere come with a standard 1-year Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) limited warranty. This warranty strictly covers manufacturing defects, dead pixels (if exceeding 3 in a cluster), and internal hardware failures.

It is crucial to note that the OEM warranty explicitly excludes accidental damage handling. Cracked screens resulting from drops during customer unboxing or incorrect self-mounting are not covered unless the customer purchased the Premium Electronics Protection Plan (PEPP) at checkout. CSRs must verify the warranty status via the OMS before dispatching any complimentary support.

2. Installation Scheduling Procedures

ShopSphere offers "White Glove" installation services for all TVs 55 inches and larger. Customers can schedule this service during checkout or add it post-purchase via the self-service portal within 14 days of delivery.

When a customer calls to modify an installation appointment, CSRs must access the Field Service Management (FSM) tool.

- **Standard Rescheduling:** Permitted up to 24 hours before the scheduled appointment with no penalty.
- **Same-Day Cancellations:** Incur a \$50 truck-roll fee, deducted from any subsequent service refund.
- **Premium Customer Benefits:** ShopSphere Premium members have their White Glove installation fees completely waived and are granted priority time-slot selection in the FSM.

3. Basic Troubleshooting and Technician Escalation

If a customer reports a malfunctioning television, Tier 1 agents must run through the standard product diagnostics procedures before initiating an OEM claim.

Agents must guide the customer to perform a power cycle (unplugging the TV for 60 seconds) and a factory reset via the settings menu. If the issue persists (e.g., audio delays, continuous boot-looping), the CSR must escalate the ticket to a Tier 2 Technical Specialist. The Tier 2 agent has the authority to remotely access the TV's diagnostic logs with the customer's permission.

If remote product diagnostics confirm a hardware failure, the Tier 2 agent will initiate a technician escalation. The FSM tool will automatically schedule a local Samsung-certified field technician. The standard repair timeline for a dispatched technician is 3 to 5 business days, pending parts availability in the local warehouse.

4. Replacement Approval Conditions

In the event that the field technician deems the Samsung TV "unrepairable" or if the required replacement part is backordered for more than 15 calendar days, the ticket shifts to a replacement workflow. Under these replacement approval conditions, the CSR will issue an Exchange Return Merchandise Authorization (RMA). The defective unit will be retrieved by logistics, and a brand-new replacement unit of the exact same model will be dispatched. Upgrades are not permitted under the standard OEM warranty workflow.

KB-012: Washing Machine Troubleshooting and Service Requests

Document Owner: Large Appliance Support | **Applicability:** Tier 1 Support, Field Coordinators | **Related Systems:** FSM, Diagnostic Portal

1. Scope of Support

Large appliances present unique logistical challenges due to their size and necessity. This document details the troubleshooting, technician dispatch, and repair timelines associated with ShopSphere's washing machine catalog (including front-load, top-load, and washer-dryer combos). CSRs are expected to attempt remote resolution whenever safely possible to minimize unnecessary field dispatches, which carry high operational costs.

2. Initial Product Diagnostics Procedures

When a customer reports an issue, the CSR must classify the problem using the Diagnostic Portal. Do not immediately escalate to a technician for non-critical errors.

- **Drainage Issues (Error Codes starting with E- or 5C):** Instruct the customer to locate the debris filter door at the bottom of the unit. Guide them to place a towel down, open the filter, and remove any coins, lint, or blockages.
- **Vibration and Noise:** Ask the customer to verify if the transit bolts (used for shipping) were removed during installation. If the transit bolts are still installed, running the machine will cause severe damage that voids the warranty eligibility. Also, instruct the customer to check the unit's leveling feet.
- **No Power:** Verify the customer has checked the circuit breaker and ensure the machine is not plugged into an extension cord, which is a fire hazard and a violation of the usage policy.

3. Field Service Scheduling and SLAs

If initial product diagnostics fail to resolve the issue, a service request must be generated. ShopSphere maintains strict Service Level Agreements (SLAs) for large appliance repairs.

For standard customers, the SLA dictates that a certified appliance technician must arrive within 5 business days of the ticket creation. ShopSphere Premium members receive an expedited SLA of 48 business hours. During the scheduling process in the FSM, the CSR must clearly document the exact error codes and diagnostic steps taken so the field technician can requisition the correct replacement pumps or motors before arriving.

4. Technician Escalation and Repair Timelines

Upon arrival, the technician will evaluate the machine. If parts are on hand, the repair is completed immediately. However, if major components (such as the central drum or main control board) must be ordered, the repair timeline is extended. The maximum allowable repair timeline for washing machines is 14 calendar days from the date of the initial diagnostic visit.

If the 14-day threshold is breached, the technician escalation protocol requires the Field Coordinator to authorize a "Lemon Replacement."

5. Replacement Approval Conditions

The Lemon Replacement policy dictates that if a washing machine cannot be repaired within the 14-day timeline, or if the same machine has required three separate major repairs within a 12-month period, the customer is entitled to a full replacement. The CSR will orchestrate a "Swap Delivery," wherein the logistics team delivers the new unit and hauls away the defective unit simultaneously, minimizing disruption to the customer.

KB-013: Laptop Replacement and Repair Policy

Document Owner: IT & Electronics Operations | **Applicability:** PC Support Tier 1 & 2 | **Related Systems:** Mail-In Repair Portal, OMS

1. Policy Overview

This document covers the support protocols for all Windows and Apple laptops purchased through ShopSphere. Laptop support relies primarily on a "Mail-In Depot" repair model rather than field service. Understanding the distinction between manufacturer defects and user-inflicted damage is critical for properly managing repair timelines and customer expectations.

2. Warranty vs. Accidental Damage Handling

All laptops include a standard 1-year OEM warranty covering hardware malfunctions (e.g., keyboard failure, motherboard failure, dead batteries). However, laptops are highly mobile and susceptible to drops and liquid spills.

The standard warranty immediately voids if the depot inspection reveals liquid damage indicators have been tripped or if the chassis exhibits impact damage. Accidental damage

handling is exclusively processed through the Premium Electronics Protection Plan (PEPP). If a customer without PEPP sends in a laptop with physical damage, the repair depot will generate an out-of-warranty repair quote. The customer has 7 days to pay the quote, or the unrepaired device will be shipped back at their expense.

3. Diagnostic and Repair Timelines

When a customer experiences a laptop issue, the CSR must initiate a Mail-In Repair RMA. A prepaid shipping box is dispatched to the customer.

Standard SLAs:

- **Transit to Depot:** 2 to 3 business days.
- **Depot Diagnostics:** The technicians have 48 hours to complete product diagnostics procedures upon receipt and update the OMS.
- **Repair Execution:** Standard hardware repairs take 5 to 7 business days.
- **Total Turnaround:** Customers should expect a total turnaround repair timeline of 10 to 14 business days.

ShopSphere Premium customers bypass the standard queue. Their laptops are triaged with overnight shipping, and depot diagnostics and repair are compressed into a strict 3-business-day turnaround SLA.

4. Replacement Approval Conditions

Laptops are heavily prioritized for repair over replacement due to data migration complexities and high unit costs. Replacement approval conditions are only met under the following edge cases:

- The motherboard and primary processor have failed simultaneously within the first 30 days of ownership (Dead on Arrival / Early Life Failure).
- The depot is unable to source replacement components from the OEM within 21 calendar days.
- The device has been lost in transit by ShopSphere's authorized logistics partner during the return journey from the repair depot.

5. Data Privacy and Prep

Before a customer ships their laptop for repair, CSRs are strictly mandated to advise the customer regarding data privacy.

CSRs must read the following script: *"ShopSphere and our repair partners are not responsible for lost data. You must back up all sensitive files. For your privacy, please remove any BIOS*

passwords and sign out of your operating system accounts, or provide the local login PIN on the intake form." If a laptop arrives with a locked BIOS and the customer cannot be reached to provide the password within 48 hours, the laptop is returned unrepai

KB-014: Smart Device Technical Support Workflow

Document Owner: IoT Support Operations | **Applicability:** Smart Home Support Agents | **Related Systems:** IoT Diagnostic Dashboard, OMS

1. Workflow Objective

The Smart Device Technical Support Workflow governs the handling of Internet of Things (IoT) products, including smart speakers, smart thermostats, security cameras, and connected lighting. Unlike major appliances or laptops, smart devices rarely undergo physical repair; they are highly integrated, sealed units. Consequently, support focuses heavily on network troubleshooting and immediate unit replacement for validated hardware failures.

2. Tier 1 Product Diagnostics Procedures

The vast majority of smart device complaints relate to connectivity or software configuration rather than physical hardware failure. Tier 1 agents must utilize the IoT Diagnostic Dashboard to run remote signal checks if the device is registered to the ShopSphere cloud.

Agents must guide the customer through the standard connectivity checklist:

1. Verify the device is within 30 feet of the wireless router.
2. Ensure the customer's mobile device and the smart device are on the same 2.4GHz Wi-Fi band (most IoT devices do not support 5GHz networks).
3. Instruct the customer to perform a "hard reset" by holding the device's reset button for 15 seconds until the LED indicator flashes amber.

3. Tier 2 Escalation and Network Troubleshooting

If the device refuses to pair after a hard reset, the ticket requires a Tier 2 technician escalation. Tier 2 agents handle complex network topology issues. They will assist the customer in logging into their home router's admin panel to adjust firewall settings, disable AP Isolation, or change DNS configurations.

If the Tier 2 agent determines the customer's home network is blocking the device, ShopSphere is not liable for replacement. However, if the Tier 2 agent confirms the device's internal Wi-Fi radio has failed, they will approve an immediate replacement.

4. Defective Unit RMA Process

Because smart devices are typically inexpensive relative to the cost of manual labor, ShopSphere does not repair them. Once a Tier 2 agent validates a hardware failure, they initiate an "Advanced Exchange RMA."

Under this workflow, ShopSphere instantly ships a new replacement unit to the customer. The customer is required to place the defective unit in the replacement's box and use the included return label to send it back. If the defective unit is not scanned by the carrier within 14 days, the customer's payment method is charged for the full retail price of the replacement unit.

5. Intersections with Premium Customer Benefits

Standard customers must complete the full Tier 2 diagnostic process before an Advanced Exchange RMA is authorized. However, ShopSphere Premium customer benefits include "No Questions Asked" fast-track replacements for smart home devices under \$150. A Tier 1 agent can immediately authorize the Advanced Exchange for a Premium member without executing the full network troubleshooting checklist.

KB-015: Premium Electronics Protection Plan

Document Owner: Extended Warranties & Risk | **Applicability:** All Support Agents, Claims Adjusters |

Related Systems: Claims Management Portal, OMS, FSM

1. Program Overview

The Premium Electronics Protection Plan (PEPP) is ShopSphere's flagship extended warranty and accident protection service. Customers can purchase PEPP at checkout or within 30 days of receiving an eligible electronic device (TVs, Laptops, Appliances, and Smart Devices). This document defines the comprehensive coverage provided by the plan, the claims workflow, and how it overrides standard OEM warranty limitations.

2. Comprehensive Warranty Eligibility and Duration

While standard OEM warranties last for 1 year and only cover manufacturing defects, PEPP extends the mechanical failure coverage for an additional 2 to 4 years (depending on the specific tier purchased). Furthermore, PEPP includes "No-Lemon" coverage, power surge protection, and free battery replacements for laptops if the battery's maximum capacity degrades below 70% of its original state.

Agents must look for the "Active PEPP" badge on the customer's CRM profile. If present, standard troubleshooting protocols are significantly shortened, prioritizing rapid resolution over extensive remote diagnostics.

3. Accidental Damage Handling

The most significant value proposition of the protection plan is accidental damage handling (ADH). ADH covers drops, liquid spills, cracked screens, and unintentional physical breakage.

Exclusions to ADH:

- Intentional damage or extreme abuse (e.g., throwing a smart device against a wall).
- Cosmetic damage that does not affect functionality (e.g., scratches on a washing machine door).
- Loss or theft of the device.

Coverage Type	Standard OEM Warranty	PEPP Coverage
Mechanical Failure	1 Year	Up to 5 Years
Accidental Drops / Spills	Not Covered	Fully Covered (\$0 Deductible)
Power Surge Damage	Not Covered	Fully Covered
Wear & Tear / Battery Degradation	Not Covered	Fully Covered

4. Expedited Repair Timelines and SLAs

PEPP radically alters the standard service SLAs discussed in product-specific documentation.

- **In-Home Service (TVs and Washers):** A technician escalation for a PEPP customer guarantees a next-business-day visit, superseding the standard 5-day SLA.

- **Depot Service (Laptops):** Devices covered by PEPP are routed to the "Priority Lane" at the mail-in depot, ensuring a maximum repair timeline of 3 business days from receipt to outbound shipping.

5. Replacement Claim Workflow

If a device covered by PEPP requires replacement, the replacement approval conditions are heavily relaxed. If a repair cannot be completed within the expedited SLA window, or if the cost of repair exceeds 75% of the device's current retail value, the Claims Adjuster will immediately approve a "Buyout."

Instead of forcing the customer to wait for backordered parts, ShopSphere will issue ShopSphere Store Credit equal to the original purchase price of the device (including taxes). The customer can use this credit to purchase a new device immediately. The defective, bought-out device must still be returned to ShopSphere via a prepaid label, or the store credit will be retroactively invalidated.